

On Cloud 9.10

Q How did Ubuntu originate?

A Ubuntu is a community developed and supported project. Since its launch in October 2004, Ubuntu has become one of the most highly regarded Linux distributions with millions of users around the world.

Ubuntu will always be free to download, free to use and free to distribute. With these goals in mind, Ubuntu aims to be the most widely used Linux system, and is the centre of a global open source software ecosystem. It contains all the applications you need — a web browser, an office suite, media apps, instant messaging and more.

At Ubuntu we promise that:

- Ubuntu will always be free of charge, along with its regular enterprise releases and security updates
- Ubuntu comes with full commercial support from Canonical and hundreds of companies from across the world
- Ubuntu provides the best translations and accessibility features that the free software community has to offer
- Ubuntu core applications are all free and open source. We want you to use free and open source software, improve it and pass it on.

Q What does Ubuntu mean?

A Ubuntu is an African word meaning 'Humanity to others', or 'I am what I am because of who we all are'. The Ubuntu distribution brings the spirit of Ubuntu to the software world.

Q Do you imagine that Ubuntu could be what Windows is today?

A When we started Ubuntu, our objective was to give customers an operating system of choice. Today we have come a long way and are comparable to Windows in terms of usability and features. We are already doing a lot of work in the usability front to

redefine the desktop. Going forward we expect to exceed what Windows does today in terms of ease of use and functionality.

Q What's unique about Ubuntu?

A Everything you need comes on one CD, providing a complete working environment. Additional software is available online. The CD is a live CD and Ubuntu can be used from the CD or from a pen drive. The graphical installer enables you to get up and running quickly and easily. A standard installation should take less than 25 minutes.

It's free, open source and we don't charge licence or subscription fees. It has a large collection of open source applications which can be easily downloaded and installed.

Q What's new in 9.10?

A Version 9.10 includes the latest OpenOffice 3.1 that supports Microsoft Office 2007 documents. Also, it has Firefox 3.5 with significantly improved performance. Additionally, 9.10 has better support for 3G connectivity, and has large scale user experience improvements.

Ubuntu One provides an enhanced desktop experience, simplifies backup, synchronisation, and sharing of files with an expanded set of features including Tomboy Notes and contacts synchronisation. It has a faster file system with Ext4 and finally faster boot time.

Q What about Ubuntu's limitations?

Any possibilities of well known applications such as Photoshop, PDF converters being available for Ubuntu?

A Yes PDF conversion facility is built into OpenOffice, you don't need to purchase any additional software. In fact there are lots of interesting plugins available for OpenOffice that can also



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edit PDFs. While Photoshop is not available on Ubuntu, we bundle Gimp for similar functionality.

Q What about Ubuntu's enterprise and server level capabilities?

A We have released Ubuntu Server with support for cloud computing. With this capability, we are the first operating system to support private clouds. While organisations love the concept of a cloud, they do not prefer it due to security concerns. With Ubuntu Server, they can take advantage of the cloud and also keep the data in their own data centre.

Q Any India specific plans for Ubuntu?

A We are working with several major OEMs in India. We already have a tieup with Dell and have recently tried up with Simmtronics to ship with netbooks pre-installed with Ubuntu. 